

INFLUENCING PEOPLE

Alliance University | Audit Course Exam

MCQ Study Guide

Coursera • 4-week course • Basic one-line MCQ exam

Prepared By @alliance.guide INSTAGRAM

Exam date	_____
Total marks	50 MCQs (1 mark each)
Duration	1 hour
Pass mark	25 / 50 (50%)
Question style	Short, direct, one-line, factual

COURSE SCHEDULE

Week / Module	Theme	Core idea
1 — Module 1	Build & leverage your power	What power is, the 6 bases, benefits & dark side
2 — Module 2	Influence without authority	10-tactic toolkit: social proof, framing, anchoring...
3 — Module 3	Leverage relationships	Networks, dependence, currencies, energy
4 — Module 4	Protect from unwanted influence	3 protection strategies, influence vs manipulation

Fill in your exam date above. Module numbers follow the 4-week structure (Week = Module).

<https://alliance-guide.vercel.app/>

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How to Use This Guide & Colour Legend

VERY IMPORTANT Red box = very important / high-chance MCQ

Learn these first. If you only have 30 minutes, read only the red boxes and the Final Cheat Sheet.

COMMON CONFUSION Teal box = common confusion explained

Two ideas that sound alike but differ. Examiners love to swap them in the wrong options.

DEFINITION Yellow box = definition to remember

One-line definitions. Many questions are literally 'Which of these defines X?'

Inline highlight: **yellow-highlighted words** are the exact key word or number the MCQ answer hinges on.

Red bold text marks a warning or trap.

Suggested study plan

- **Pass 1 (read):** each module's notes — read the boxes, skim the rest.
- **Pass 2 (test):** do each module's practice MCQs, check answers, re-read what you missed.
- **Pass 3 (cram):** Final Cheat Sheet + Critical Facts tables + Confusion Busters.
- **Pass 4 (simulate):** the 50-question mock drill in 45 minutes. Aim for 40+ so the real pass mark (25) is easy.

Exam strategy (50 marks, 1 hour, pass = 25)

- Roughly **1 minute per question**; skip hard ones and return.
- Answer every question — **no hint of negative marking** was given, but check your paper's rules.
- Watch for **NOT / EXCEPT** questions: find the 3 true options, the odd one out is the answer.
- Numbers matter: **62%, 76%, 20%, 25%, 2-3 ft, 50%, 4 currencies, 3 strategies**.
- Where options feel similar (e.g. availability vs anchoring), recall the **example**: vivid story = availability; first number = anchor.

COMMON CONFUSION A note on study figures

The numbers in this guide (Milgram **62%**, Asch **76%**) are **the figures used in the course videos**. Some textbooks quote slightly different values (e.g. ~65% and ~75%). If your exam is based on the course, use the course figures.

MODULE 1 — Build & Leverage Your Power

Syllabus blueprint

Topic	What to know	Priority
Definitions of power	Weber, French & Raven, Emerson, Depret & Fiske	HIGH
Core attributes	Relative, contextual, formalization, stability, valued outcomes, actual + perceptual	HIGH
6 bases of power	Reward, Coercive, Legitimate, Referent, Expert, Information	HIGH
3 categories	Structural, Personal, Cognitive	HIGH
Benefits of power	Action, creativity, less burden, health, career	HIGH
Dark side of power	Overconfidence, poor advice-taking, self-focus, team harm	HIGH
Priming & beliefs	Cognitive bases; stereotypes	MED
Building power	Symbols, connections, non-monetary rewards, expertise, info, charisma	MED

1.1 What is power?

DEFINITION Power

Control over **valued resources or outcomes**. It is the **potential** to influence — not the act of influencing itself.

DEFINITION Influence

Affecting others' **behaviour, decisions or direction** — often indirectly but importantly. Power is the source; influence is the result.

Who	Definition (key word)
Weber	Carry out your own will / achieve goals despite resistance
French & Raven	The maximum potential ability of A to influence B — a foundation, not an act
Emerson	Control over things another person values
Depret & Fiske	Asymmetrical control over another's outcomes

VERY IMPORTANT Core attributes of power (6)

1) **Relative** — depends on the relationship 2) **Contextual** — depends on situation 3) Control varies in **formalization** 4) Control varies in **stability** 5) **Valued outcomes** differ by person 6) **Actual + perceptual** (exists in reality AND in people's minds)

COMMON CONFUSION Power vs influence

Power = **potential** (the foundation). Influence = **actual effect**. A boss may have power but fail to influence.

1.2 The six bases of power

Base	Meaning	Category
Reward	Ability to give rewards — also non-monetary (support, benefits, favours)	Structural
Coercive	Ability to punish or force compliance	Structural
Legitimate	Formal right to influence via title / hierarchy / reporting line	Structural
Referent	Charisma, attraction, identification — can be learned	Personal
Expert	Valued or rare expertise	Personal
Information	Valued or rare information (you need not be the expert)	Personal

VERY IMPORTANT Three categories of power bases

Structural (rooted in position): legitimate + reward + coercion. **Personal** (rooted in you): expertise + information + referent. **Cognitive** (rooted in thoughts/feelings): **priming + beliefs**.

Memory trick: **S**tructural = **S**eat (position); **P**ersonal = **P**erson; **C**ognitive = **C**ortex (mind).

COMMON CONFUSION Expert vs Information power

Expert = you have valued skill/knowledge. **Information** = you merely hold valued/rare information — even if you're not the expert (e.g. an assistant who knows the CEO's schedule).

COMMON CONFUSION Legitimate vs Referent

Legitimate = power from your **title/position**. Referent = power from being **liked/admired** — no title needed.

1.3 Cognitive bases — priming & beliefs

DEFINITION Priming

Cues or instructions that make someone **feel powerful or powerless** (e.g. being assigned supervisor vs subordinate, or writing about a time you had power).

DEFINITION Beliefs

Internalised, often **cultural** ideas about who is powerful (gender, minority status, age, tenure). **Stereotypes** can enhance or constrain felt power.

1.4 Benefits of power

- **Action / proactivity** — act without waiting for a boss.
- **Creativity ↑**, **conformity ↓**.
- **Burden ↓** — less felt weight of responsibility.
- **Health** — cardiac output ↑, vascular resistance ↓.
- **Career** advancement and resource access.

1.5 Dark side of power

VERY IMPORTANT Risks of feeling powerful (5)

- 1) **Overconfidence** (too certain on too little info)
- 2) **Advice-taking ↓** — even for experts
- 3) **Self-focus ↑**, others ↓
- 4) Powerful leader **talks more**, open communication ↓
- 5) **Team performance ↓** (wrong decisions)

COMMON CONFUSION Confidence vs overconfidence

Confidence is fine. **Overconfidence** = high certainty with little information — that is the risk.

1.6 Building power (practical)

- **Structural**: use symbols & artifacts (medals, uniforms, credentials, titles); stress connections to higher-power people (selectively — overuse dilutes); expand rewards beyond money (support, benefits, favours). Promotion is **not** the only path.
- **Personal**: build expertise/information that is **valued or rare**; become an info broker; develop charisma (learnable). Holders of structural power still need personal power.
- **Don't** keep saying 'I'm the boss' — symbols work better than announcements.

Practice MCQs — Module 1

Q1. Which is NOT one of the six bases of power?

- A. Positional power
- B. Reward power
- C. Referent power
- D. Information power

Q2. Which set lists the STRUCTURAL bases?

- A. Expert, information, referent
- B. Legitimate, reward, coercive
- C. Priming, beliefs, referent
- D. Reward, expert, referent

Q3. Priming and beliefs belong to which category?

- A. Cognitive
- B. Coercive
- C. Personal
- D. Structural

Q4. Weber defined power as achieving goals...

- A. Through rewards only
- B. Only via formal title
- C. Despite resistance
- D. With full consent

Q5. 'Maximum potential ability of A to influence B' is whose definition?

- A. Weber
- B. Depret & Fiske
- C. French & Raven
- D. Emerson

Q6. 'Control over things another person values' is whose definition?

- A. Depret & Fiske
- B. Weber
- C. French & Raven
- D. Emerson

Q7. Which is a dark-side effect of power?

- A. Higher creativity
- B. Reduced advice-taking
- C. Lower burden
- D. More conformity

Q8. Referent power is mainly based on...

- A. Rank in hierarchy
- B. Rare technical skill
- C. Ability to punish
- D. Charisma / attraction

Q9. Power is best described as...

- A. Actual act of influencing
- B. Formal title only
- C. Always absolute
- D. Potential to influence

Q10. Which is a health benefit linked to feeling powerful?

- A. Higher blood pressure
- B. Higher cardiac output, lower vascular resistance
- C. Lower testosterone
- D. Higher cortisol

ANSWERS & WHY

Q1: A	Positional power — Six bases: Reward, Coercive, Legitimate, Referent, Expert, Information.
Q2: B	Legitimate, reward, coercive — Structural = position-rooted.
Q3: A	Cognitive — Cognitive bases = priming + beliefs.
Q4: C	Despite resistance — Weber = despite resistance.
Q5: C	French & Raven — F&R: potential, a foundation.
Q6: D	Emerson — Emerson = valued things.
Q7: B	Reduced advice-taking — Creativity ↑ and burden ↓ are benefits.
Q8: D	Charisma / attraction — Referent = charisma; it can be learned.
Q9: D	Potential to influence — Power = potential; it's relative & contextual.
Q10: B	Higher cardiac output, lower vascular resistance — Benefit of power.

MODULE 2 — Influence Without Authority

Syllabus blueprint

Topic	What to know	Priority
Toolkit of 10	Social proof, authority, availability, framing, anchoring, liking, scarcity, reciprocity, non-verbals, timing	HIGH
Prospect theory	Gain → risk-averse; loss → risk-seeking	HIGH
Body language	High-power pose: T ↑20%, cortisol ↓25%	HIGH
Proxemics	2-3 ft sweet spot; <64 cm discomfort	MED
Studies	Milgram, Asch, bystander, towel, parole board	HIGH
Michigan Model	4 purposes of influence	MED
Directions of influence	Upward, lateral, downward, external; white spaces	MED

VERY IMPORTANT Influence toolkit — 10 tactics in order

Social proof · Authority · Availability · Framing · Anchoring · Liking · Scarcity · Reciprocity · Non-verbals · Timing (time of day / glucose)

2.1 Influence without formal authority

- Directions: **upward** (boss/exec committee), **lateral** (peers), **downward** (without ordering), **external** (customers, suppliers, partners).
- White spaces** = activity areas between verticals where authority is limited. **Matrix structure** = organised by products AND customer groups/geographies.
- Michigan Model of Leadership** — influence to: **change · community/teamwork · results under pressure · process/efficiency**.
- Fixed action patterns** = automatic responses (e.g. saying 'bless you'); why tactics work fast.

2.2 Social proof

DEFINITION Social proof

Resolving uncertainty by **copying what similar others do**. Strongest when **uncertain** AND the source is **similar**.

- Triggers: benchmarking, best-seller lists, canned laughter, endorsements, public votes.
- Towel study**: 'most guests reuse' message → **26% more** reuse; **75%** of guests reused.
- Bystander effect**: alone people help **>90%**; with ≥2 passive bystanders only **16%**.
- Phillips study**: suicide spikes up to **1,000%** lasting **7-10 days**, only where publicised.
- Asch**: **76%** gave a wrong answer at least once under group pressure (alone: **>99%** correct).

COMMON CONFUSION Normative vs informational influence

Normative = go along to avoid discomfort of disagreeing. **Informational** = genuinely believing the majority must be right.

2.3 Authority

DEFINITION Authority (as influence)

Complying with **symbols** of authority (attire, title, trappings) — not real authority.

- Milgram**: **62%** went to **450V**; 30 switches, 15V steps; experimenter in white coat who 'took responsibility'.
- Nurses obeyed a phone 'doctor'; drivers honked later at an expensive car; jaywalker in a suit was followed **3.5x**.
- Business attire** triggers authority (and liking). Titles, uniforms, jargon, degree mentions all work.

COMMON CONFUSION Authority vs legitimate power

Authority tactic = respond to the **symbols**. Legitimate power = **actual** formal right. On the receiving end, check **legitimacy & pertinence**.

2.4 Availability, framing & anchoring — the three that get mixed up

VERY IMPORTANT Availability / Framing / Anchoring in one line each

Availability — vivid, salient, easy-to-recall info outweighs facts (stories, prototypes, a live dissatisfied customer).

Framing (prospect theory, Kahneman & Tversky, Nobel 2002) — **gain frame** → **risk-AVERSE**; **loss frame** → **risk-SEEKING**.

Anchoring — the **first number** sets the reference; adjustment is incremental. Make the **first offer**; **speak first** in meetings.

COMMON CONFUSION Anchoring vs availability

Anchoring = a **number** stated first. Availability = a **vivid image or story** easy to remember.

- Framing example: sure gain of 500 vs 50% chance of 1,000 → most choose the sure thing (gain = risk averse). Plant-closing: Plan A framed as gain wins.
- Anchoring examples: IT budget **1.5M** (low) vs **2.3M** (competitors); sales growth **5%** vs **7.5%**; **2.5%** vs **9%**.

2.5 Liking, scarcity, reciprocity

Tactic	Idea	Key facts / examples
Liking	Say yes to people we know & like	Physical attractiveness ↑ tips, votes, legal outcomes; implicit personality theory (attractive = positive traits); neat dress; similarities; short dialogue before request (~ 3x compliance)
Scarcity	Less available = more valuable	2-cookie jar rated better than 10-cookie jar; limited quantity, time limits, exclusive info; use only if true
Reciprocity	Obligation to return benefits	\$5 with survey beats promised \$50 later; address-label gift; DAV 18% → 35% ; give first, give broadly

COMMON CONFUSION Reciprocity vs liking vs quid pro quo

Reciprocity = give **first**, obligation follows. Liking = we say yes because we **like** the person. Quid pro quo (M3) = explicit **'I do this if you do that'**.

2.6 Non-verbals, proxemics & timing

VERY IMPORTANT High-power pose

Open posture: testosterone ↑ ~**20%**, cortisol ↓ ~**25%**. Closed posture does the opposite. Use a high-power pose **before** an interview/presentation.

- Good: eye contact, **mirroring**, relaxed face, illustrational gestures, palms up/perpendicular, firm handshake. Avoid: hands in pockets / behind back.
- Proxemics**: **2-3 ft** sweet spot; **<64 cm (2 ft)** = discomfort; influence drops beyond **3 ft**, more beyond **5 ft**.
- Collectivistic cultures (China, Russia, Poland, India) accept **less** space; individualistic (US, Australia, GB, NZ) want **more**. Dense metros (New York, Moscow, London, Singapore) tolerate less space.
- Timing**: Israeli Parole Board favourable rulings fall **75% → ~0%** across a session and spike after a snack/lunch. **Glucose** is a mental resource — present early morning or after food.

COMMON CONFUSION Posing vs priming

High-power **pose** = body → physiology & feeling (non-verbal). **Priming** = cue/instruction → mindset (cognitive base, Module 1).

2.7 Building personal & cognitive power (recap)

- Personal**: identify valued expertise/info, make it visible (credentials), develop persuasion, become an information broker, develop charisma.
- Cognitive**: open postures; reminders of your position power; recall a time you had power; challenge constraining beliefs; harness enhancing ones.
- Ethics**: keep a moral compass — influence ≠ manipulation (revisited in Module 4).

Practice MCQs — Module 2

Q1. Gain framing makes people...

- A. Overconfident
- B. Indifferent
- C. Risk-averse
- D. Risk-seeking

Q2. Milgram: what % went to 450V (course figure)?

- A. 26%
- B. 76%
- C. 62%
- D. 3.7%

Q3. Which tactic says 'make the FIRST offer'?

- A. Availability
- B. Liking
- C. Anchoring
- D. Scarcity

Q4. Social proof is strongest when...

- A. Nobody else has acted
- B. The audience is tired
- C. The situation is uncertain and others are similar
- D. You hold formal power

Q5. High-power pose changes hormones by...

- A. Testosterone ↑ ~20%, cortisol ↓ ~25%
- B. Both ↓ 25%
- C. Both ↑ 20%
- D. Testosterone ↓ 25%, cortisol ↑ 20%

Q6. The proxemics 'sweet spot' for influence is...

- A. Under 1 foot
- B. Over 8 feet
- C. 5-6 feet
- D. 2-3 feet

Q7. The 2-cookie vs 10-cookie jar study illustrates...

- A. Scarcity
- B. Anchoring
- C. Reciprocity
- D. Liking

Q8. DAV response rate rose 18% → 35% with...

- A. Public voting
- B. A deadline
- C. A small gift (reciprocity)
- D. A celebrity signature

Q9. Complying with attire, titles and trappings is...

- A. Framing
- B. Social proof
- C. Availability
- D. Authority as influence

Q10. Israeli Parole Board study shows...

- A. Authority raises approvals
- B. Decisions worsen as the session goes on and recover after food
- C. Judges prefer morning only
- D. Gain framing beats loss

Q11. Which is NOT a Michigan Model purpose of influence?

- A. Build community/teamwork
- B. Increase personal wealth
- C. Drive change
- D. Deliver results under pressure

Q12. Vivid story, live dissatisfied customer or a prototype uses...

- A.** Reciprocity
- B.** Availability heuristic
- C.** Anchoring
- D.** Scarcity

ANSWERS & WHY

Q1: C	Risk-averse — Gain → risk averse; loss → risk seeking.
Q2: C	62% — Experimenter in white coat; 30 switches.
Q3: C	Anchoring — First number sets the reference.
Q4: C	The situation is uncertain and others are similar — Uncertainty + similarity.
Q5: A	Testosterone ↑ ~20%, cortisol ↓ ~25% — Closed posture = opposite.
Q6: D	2-3 feet — <64 cm is uncomfortable.
Q7: A	Scarcity — Less available = more valuable.
Q8: C	A small gift (reciprocity) — Give first.
Q9: D	Authority as influence — Symbols, not real authority.
Q10: B	Decisions worsen as the session goes on and recover after food — 75% → ~0%; glucose.
Q11: B	Increase personal wealth — Four purposes: change, community, results, process.
Q12: B	Availability heuristic — Vivid = easily recalled.

MODULE 3 — Leverage Relationships

Syllabus blueprint

Topic	What to know	Priority
Formal chart vs network	Chart ≈ 50% of org life; network predicts outcomes	HIGH
Network structure	Dense/closed vs spanning clusters	HIGH
Dependence	Less dependent = more power; power audit	HIGH
Currencies	Cohen & Bradford: 4 types	HIGH
Reputation	Get others to tout you (Pfeffer)	MED
Energy	Energizers, Wayne Baker, discretionary effort	MED
Relationship building	Gratitude, caring, common interests	LOW

3.1 Formal chart vs informal network

VERY IMPORTANT Org chart vs network

The **formal org chart** (reporting lines) explains only about **50%** of how an organisation works. The **informal network** (who goes to whom for advice/info) predicts **promotion, money, responsibility and informal power** — even after controlling for performance, experience, tenure, rank, school, grades, tests.

- **Node** = a person; **tie** = an advice/information relationship between two people.
- **Dense / cliquish network** = everyone talks to everyone; a **cluster** = a pocket within the structure.

DEFINITION Informal power

Power from **personal, cognitive and relational** sources rather than formal authority.

3.2 Network structure — Jennifer vs John

- Both managers have 10 contacts and the same rank. **Jennifer**: dense, closed network. **John**: spans separate clusters.
- **John has more power.** Remove Jennifer → network survives. Remove John → network **collapses** ('hit-by-the-bus' test).

COMMON CONFUSION Network size vs network position

Size is not what matters (both had 10). **Position — bridging clusters** — creates informal power.

3.3 Dependence & the power audit

VERY IMPORTANT Dependence asymmetry

The **less dependent** person has **more** power. If someone gives you many hard-to-replace benefits and you give few, **they** hold the power. Example: Catherine (many benefits to Hagen, hard to replace) has more power than Hagen.

DEFINITION Power audit

List your **top 10 contacts**; score **0-10** how much **you** depend on them and how much **they** depend on you.

- **High mutual dependence** = best: robust, lasting, high commitment.
- **High-in / low-out** (you need them, they don't need you) = replaceable and vulnerable.
- If you hold the power advantage, don't exploit it: **moral and economic** reasons.

COMMON CONFUSION Mutual dependence vs asymmetry

Mutual = both depend a lot (healthy). **Asymmetry** = one depends more (the less-dependent side has the power).

3.4 Organisational currencies (Cohen & Bradford)

DEFINITION Social relationship

Defined by the **flow of benefits / resources** — 'currencies' exchanged. This is **social exchange**.

Currency type	Examples
Task-related	Budget, personnel, space, information, approval, quick response

Currency type	Examples
Relationship-related	Social favours
Position-related	Advancement, visibility
Person-related	Learning, growth, gratitude, appreciation, compliments

VERY IMPORTANT Memory trick for the 4 currencies

T-R-P-P → **T**ask, **R**elationship, **P**osition, **P**erson.

COMMON CONFUSION Quid pro quo vs reciprocity

Quid pro quo = transactional 'I do this if you do that'. **Reciprocity** = give first, obligation returns naturally. **Verbal framing**: words define the exchange value when no money is attached.

3.5 Reputation

- Reputation** = others' perception of your competence, intelligence and influence. Influential people are fought and challenged less.
- Self-advocacy dilemma**: not advocating = disadvantaged; advocating = seen as arrogant.
- Pfeffer's solution**: get **others** (boss, colleagues, friends) to tout your abilities. You don't own your reputation.

3.6 Energy networks

- Energizer**: leaves others feeling more driven. **Energy network** = map of who energizes whom (**Wayne Baker**).
- Central energizers have **many incoming** arrows; **drainers** have many outgoing, few incoming.
- Energizers get more **discretionary effort** (voluntary extra effort) → more influence.
- How to energize: genuine concern, connect beyond roles, **possibility focus / developmental mindset**, lean in, eye contact, open posture.

3.7 Relationship building

- Attitude of gratitude** (John Beilein): value everyone from maintenance to president; make all feel part of the team.
- Caring** (Jeff Brodsky): biggest contributor to relationships; recognise bad days and achievements; visible recognition; help solve problems.
- Common interests**: kids, pets, education, hometown, past work, university networks.
- Influence decision bodies via **alliances/catalysts** built **before** the meeting; watch the influential person's negative reaction.

COMMON CONFUSION Influence vs manipulation (preview)

Influence may serve the group, team or self. **Manipulation = self-advantage only**, by unfair or insidious means. People see through manipulation.

Practice MCQs — Module 3

Q1. The formal org chart explains about what share of organisational life?

- A. 100%
- B. About 50%
- C. About 10%
- D. About 90%

Q2. Who has more informal power in a relationship?

- A. The one who talks most
- B. The less dependent person
- C. The more dependent person
- D. The higher-ranked person

Q3. How many Cohen & Bradford currency types are there?

- A. 4
- B. 3
- C. 6
- D. 5

Q4. 'Gratitude, appreciation, compliments' are which currency?

- A. Position-related
- B. Person-related
- C. Task-related
- D. Relationship-related

Q5. 'Budget, space, approval, quick response' are which currency?

- A. Task-related
- B. Relationship-related
- C. Person-related
- D. Position-related

Q6. In a power audit you score contacts from...

- A. 0 to 100
- B. 1 to 5, one way
- C. 0 to 10, in both directions
- D. A to F

Q7. Which pair is the BEST situation in a power audit?

- A. No dependence
- B. High mutual dependence
- C. High-in, low-out
- D. Low-in, high-out only

Q8. Pfeffer's advice for building reputation is...

- A. Stay silent
- B. Brag more loudly
- C. Rely only on your title
- D. Get others to tout your abilities

Q9. Who mapped energy networks?

- A. Cohen & Bradford
- B. Kahneman
- C. Wayne Baker
- D. Zimbardo

Q10. Why did John have more informal power than Jennifer?

- A. He worked longer hours
- B. He had more contacts
- C. He spans separate clusters
- D. He had a higher rank

Q11. 'I do this if you do that' describes...

- A. Quid pro quo
- B. Priming
- C. Referent power
- D. Reciprocity

Q12. A tie in a network diagram is...

- A. A cluster
- B. A person
- C. An advice/information relationship
- D. A reporting line

ANSWERS & WHY

Q1: B	About 50% — Network explains the rest.
Q2: B	The less dependent person — Dependence asymmetry.
Q3: A	4 — Task, Relationship, Position, Person.
Q4: B	Person-related — Learning, growth, gratitude = person.
Q5: A	Task-related — Resources for the work.
Q6: C	0 to 10, in both directions — Your dependence AND theirs.
Q7: B	High mutual dependence — Robust & lasting.

Q8: D	Get others to tout your abilities — Solves the self-advocacy dilemma.
Q9: C	Wayne Baker — Energizers vs drainers.
Q10: C	He spans separate clusters — Both had 10 contacts.
Q11: A	Quid pro quo — Transactional exchange.
Q12: C	An advice/information relationship — Node = person.

MODULE 4 — Protect From Unwanted Influence

Syllabus blueprint

Topic	What to know	Priority
3 protection strategies	Minimise biases · Flip the tactic · Reframe the power relationship	HIGH
Defences by bias	Social proof, availability, liking	HIGH
Reframing	Change which base defines control	HIGH
Influence vs manipulation	Intent is the difference	HIGH
Studies	Asch, Milgram, Stanford Prison	HIGH

VERY IMPORTANT The 3 protection strategies

1) Minimise biases 2) Flip the influence tactic 3) Reframe the power relationship

4.1 Minimise biases

Bias used on you	Your defence
Social proof	Private vote ; record opinions independently first; build a coalition in advance; ensure ≥1 ally / devil's advocate
Availability	Keep full records (refer to the whole year); keep distance from vivid events; ask counterfactual questions (shark-attack example)
Liking	Minimise dialogue before a decision/negotiation, especially face-to-face (car salesperson example)

DEFINITION Counterfactuals

Alternative explanations that challenge vivid information ('what else could explain this?').

DEFINITION Unwanted influence / coalition / private vote

Unwanted influence = influence you or your team don't want. **Coalition** = pre-built support so you're not a lone minority. **Private vote** = independent recording that removes social proof.

4.2 Flip the influence tactic

Use the other side's tactic (**scarcity, availability, social proof**) to offset theirs. The course examples are brief, so remember only: **flip = use their tactic back**.

4.3 Reframe the power relationship

DEFINITION Reframing

Shift to a **base of power you hold** to reduce the other person's control (and your dependence).

- Multiple power sources are always in play — identify the base used on you.
- Don't undermine your manager's legitimate power**. Use your **expertise or information** instead.
- If they use expertise, **minimise it for that situation** and bring your own relevant information.

COMMON CONFUSION Flip vs reframe

Flip = use the **same tactic** back (e.g. their scarcity, your scarcity). **Reframe** = change **which base of power** defines the relationship.

4.4 Influence vs manipulation

VERY IMPORTANT Intent is the difference

Influence may serve the group, team or self. **Manipulation** = controlling someone by unfair/insidious means for **self-gain only**. Keep a moral compass; people see through manipulation. Instructor: avoid manipulation as a strategy.

COMMON CONFUSION Influence vs coercion

Coercion = forcing/punishing (a structural base). Manipulation = playing on someone unfairly. Influence = legitimate effect on others.

4.5 The classic studies (all together)

Study	Who / when	Finding to remember
Milgram	Early 1960s — obedience	62% to 450V; white coat; psychiatrists predicted 3.7% at 300V and <0.1% at 450V
Asch	1956 — line-length conformity	Alone >99% correct; under group pressure 76% wrong at least once; private writing → wrong answers drop >2/3; ≥2 correct allies → 95% correct
Stanford Prison	Zimbardo, early 1970s	Guards commanded, controlled and sometimes tortured prisoners — power for evil

COMMON CONFUSION Milgram vs Asch vs Stanford

Milgram = obedience to **authority**. **Asch** = **conformity** to a group. **Stanford** = **abuse of power** in assigned roles (Zimbardo).

Practice MCQs — Module 4

Q1. Which is NOT one of the 3 protection strategies?

- A. Minimise biases
- B. Increase your authority
- C. Flip the influence tactic
- D. Reframe the power relationship

Q2. Best defence against social proof is...

- A. Wait for the vivid event
- B. Private vote and a coalition
- C. Add more experts
- D. Longer dialogue

Q3. Best defence against the liking tactic is...

- A. Increase small talk
- B. Vote publicly
- C. Minimise dialogue before deciding
- D. Offer a gift

Q4. Counterfactual questions defend against...

- A. Anchoring
- B. Authority
- C. Scarcity
- D. Availability heuristic

Q5. Reframing the power relationship means...

- A. Voting privately
- B. Using the same tactic back
- C. Escaping the relationship
- D. Shifting to a base of power you hold

Q6. Manipulation differs from influence because it is...

- A. For self-advantage only, by unfair means
- B. Always illegal
- C. Never effective
- D. Based on rewards

Q7. The Stanford Prison Experiment was by...

- A. Kahneman
- B. Zimbardo
- C. Milgram
- D. Asch

Q8. In Asch's study, having ≥2 correct allies led to ~...

- A. 10% correct
- B. 95% correct
- C. 50% correct
- D. 76% correct

Q9. Which study is about conformity to a group?

- A. Milgram
- B. Phillips
- C. Stanford Prison
- D. Asch

Q10. Using the other side's tactic (e.g. scarcity) back on them is...

- A. Anchoring
- B. Priming
- C. Reframing
- D. Flipping the influence tactic

ANSWERS & WHY

Q1: B	Increase your authority — The three: minimise biases, flip tactic, reframe power.
Q2: B	Private vote and a coalition — Remove public conformity pressure.
Q3: C	Minimise dialogue before deciding — Esp. face-to-face.
Q4: D	Availability heuristic — Challenge vivid information.
Q5: D	Shifting to a base of power you hold — Don't undermine legitimate power.
Q6: A	For self-advantage only, by unfair means — Intent is the difference.
Q7: B	Zimbardo — Guards abused prisoners.
Q8: B	95% correct — Allies break conformity.
Q9: D	Asch — Line-length task, 1956.
Q10: D	Flipping the influence tactic — Flip = same tactic.

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FINAL CHEAT SHEET & EXAM TIPS

Memorise these 5 first

- **6 bases:** Reward, Coercive, Legitimate, Referent, Expert, Information.
- **Milgram 62% @ 450V; Asch 76% wrong at least once.**
- **High-power pose:** testosterone ↑ ~20%, cortisol ↓ ~25%.
- **Gain → risk-averse; Loss → risk-seeking** (Kahneman & Tversky, Nobel 2002).
- **3 protection strategies:** minimise biases, flip tactic, reframe power.

One-page lists

List	Items
6 bases	Reward · Coercive · Legitimate · Referent · Expert · Information
3 categories	Structural (L, R, C) · Personal (E, I, Ref) · Cognitive (priming, beliefs)
6 attributes	Relative · Contextual · Formalization · Stability · Valued outcomes · Actual + perceptual
Benefits	Action · Creativity ↑ / conformity ↓ · Burden ↓ · Health · Career
Dark side	Overconfidence · Advice-taking ↓ · Self-focus ↑ · Leader talks more · Team performance ↓
10 tactics	Social proof · Authority · Availability · Framing · Anchoring · Liking · Scarcity · Reciprocity · Non-verbals · Timing
Michigan Model	Change · Community/teamwork · Results · Process
4 currencies	Task · Relationship · Position · Person
3 protections	Minimise biases · Flip tactic · Reframe power

Last-minute exam tips

- **Name → idea:** Weber = despite resistance · F&R = potential · Emerson = valued things · D&F = asymmetrical control · Pfeffer = others tout you · Baker = energy · Zimbardo = Stanford.
- **Direction words:** gain→averse, loss→seeking; less dependent→more power; high-in/low-out→vulnerable.
- **Elimination:** cross out options that mix categories (e.g. 'expert' in a structural list).
- **Two-minute recheck:** re-read any NOT/EXCEPT question before moving on.

CRITICAL FACTS — Quick Reference

Numbers

Fact	Number	Module
Milgram — went to 450V	62%	M2/M4
Asch — wrong at least once	76%	M2/M4
Asch — alone correct	>99%	M4
Asch — ≥2 allies correct	95%	M4
Testosterone change (high-power pose)	↑ ~20%	M2
Cortisol change (high-power pose)	↓ ~25%	M2
Proxemics sweet spot	2-3 ft; <64 cm uncomfortable; drop >3 ft, more >5 ft	M2
Towel study	26% more; 75% reuse	M2
Bystander help alone / with 2+	>90% / 16%	M2
Phillips suicide spike	up to 1,000% , 7-10 days	M2
DAV response	18% → 35%	M2
Parole board favourable	75% → ~0%	M2
Formal org chart explains	~50%	M3
Kahneman & Tversky Nobel	2002	M2
Milgram setup	30 switches, 15V steps	M2

Names

Name	Associated with
Weber / French & Raven / Emerson / Depret & Fiske	Definitions of power
Kahneman & Tversky	Prospect theory / framing
Milgram	Obedience to authority
Asch	Conformity
Zimbardo	Stanford Prison Experiment
Cohen & Bradford	Organisational currencies
Pfeffer	Reputation — get others to tout you
Wayne Baker	Energy networks
John Beilein	Attitude of gratitude
Jeff Brodsky	Caring in relationships

Confusion busters

Often confused	How to tell them apart
Power vs influence	Power = potential; influence = actual effect
Expert vs information power	Expert = skill/knowledge; information = rare info held
Legitimate vs referent	Title/position vs liked/admired
Anchoring vs availability	First number vs vivid story
Social proof vs authority	Copy similar others vs obey symbols/status
Reciprocity vs quid pro quo	Give first vs explicit trade
Posing vs priming	Body posture vs cue/instruction
Flip vs reframe	Same tactic back vs change which power base

Often confused	How to tell them apart
Influence vs manipulation	Intent: self-gain only = manipulation
Milgram / Asch / Stanford	Obedience / conformity / abuse of power
Mutual dependence vs asymmetry	Both depend a lot vs one depends more

MOCK EXAM DRILL — 50 Questions

DEFINITION Instructions

Set a timer for **45 minutes**. Cover the answers (next page). Pass mark in the real exam = **25/50**; aim for **40+** here.

Q1. Power is best defined as the...

- A. Act of influencing
- B. Formal title
- C. Right to punish
- D. Potential to influence

Q2. Which base can be learned by anyone?

- A. Legitimate
- B. Reward
- C. Referent (charisma)
- D. Coercive

Q3. Which is a cognitive base of power?

- A. Information
- B. Reward
- C. Priming
- D. Expert

Q4. Weber's definition emphasises...

- A. Despite resistance
- B. Full consent
- C. Reward only
- D. Title only

Q5. Which is a benefit of power?

- A. Creativity ↑
- B. Conformity ↑
- C. Burden ↑
- D. Advice-taking ↑

Q6. Which is a dark side of power?

- A. Overconfidence
- B. Proactivity
- C. Better health
- D. Lower burden

Q7. Information power means...

- A. Giving rewards
- B. Having a title
- C. Being liked
- D. Holding valued or rare information

Q8. Structural bases are rooted in...

- A. Charisma
- B. Beliefs
- C. Expertise
- D. Position

Q9. Emerson: power is control over things another...

- A. Fears
- B. Owns
- C. Values
- D. Ignores

Q10. Depret & Fiske: power is...

- A. Mutual dependence
- B. Equal control
- C. Asymmetrical control over outcomes
- D. Resistance to authority

Q11. Powerful leaders who talk too much hurt...

- A. Creativity only
- B. Their salary
- C. Open communication and team performance
- D. Network size

Q12. 'Symbols and artifacts' strengthen which base?

- A. Information
- B. Legitimate
- C. Coercive
- D. Referent

Q13. Loss framing leads people to be...

- A. Conformist
- B. Risk-seeking
- C. Risk-averse
- D. Neutral

Q14. Social proof is a tendency to...

- A. Buy scarce items
- B. Return favours
- C. Obey titles
- D. Copy similar others

Q15. Wearing business attire mainly triggers...

- A. Reciprocity
- B. Authority
- C. Scarcity
- D. Anchoring

Q16. The towel study illustrated...

- A. Framing
- B. Social proof
- C. Authority
- D. Scarcity

Q17. 'Only 3 tickets left!' uses...

- A. Anchoring
- B. Availability
- C. Scarcity
- D. Liking

Q18. Giving \$5 with a survey illustrates...

- A. Scarcity
- B. Reciprocity
- C. Liking
- D. Authority

Q19. Speaking first in a meeting uses...

- A. Availability
- B. Anchoring
- C. Social proof
- D. Framing

Q20. Implicit personality theory is linked to...

- A. Anchoring
- B. Liking / attractiveness
- C. Scarcity
- D. Authority

Q21. Mirroring someone's behaviour tends to make you appear...

- A. Aggressive
- B. Likeable and persuasive
- C. Anxious
- D. Distant

Q22. Which hormone drops ~25% after a high-power pose?

- A. Adrenaline
- B. Testosterone
- C. Cortisol
- D. Insulin

Q23. Best time to present, per timing research?

- A. Early morning or after food
- B. After a long meeting
- C. Late afternoon, hungry
- D. Just before lunch

Q24. Matrix structure organises by...

- A. Age only
- B. Random teams
- C. Products AND customers/geographies
- D. Seniority only

Q25. External influence targets...

- A. Customers, suppliers, partners
- B. Your peers
- C. Your boss
- D. Your team

Q26. White spaces are...

- A. Meeting rooms
- B. Unused budget
- C. Empty offices
- D. Areas between verticals with limited authority

Q27. Asch's experiment concerned...

- A. Reciprocity
- B. Obedience
- C. Conformity
- D. Abuse of power

Q28. Milgram's experimenter wore a...

- A. White lab coat
- B. Business suit
- C. Judge's robe
- D. Police uniform

Q29. The bystander effect: with ≥ 2 passive bystanders, help falls to...

- A. 50%
- B. 16%
- C. 76%
- D. 90%

Q30. The formal org chart explains about...

- A. 10%
- B. 100%
- C. 50% of organisational life
- D. 90%

Q31. An informal network is built from...

- A. Advice/information ties
- B. Seat locations
- C. Job titles
- D. Salary bands

Q32. In a network diagram a node is...

- A. A tie
- B. A person
- C. A currency
- D. A cluster

Q33. The person who spans clusters usually has...

- A. No power
- B. Only formal power
- C. Less power
- D. More informal power

Q34. The less dependent person in a relationship has...

- A. More power
- B. Equal power
- C. Less power
- D. No influence

Q35. 'Hit-by-the-bus' test asks whether...

- A. The network collapses if one person is removed
- B. The boss is replaced
- C. A deadline is missed
- D. The budget is cut

Q36. Cohen & Bradford identified how many currency types?

- A. 4
- B. 2
- C. 6
- D. 3

Q37. 'Advancement and visibility' are...

- A. Relationship-related
- B. Position-related currencies
- C. Person-related
- D. Task-related

Q38. 'Social favours' are...

- A. Person-related
- B. Relationship-related currencies
- C. Position-related
- D. Task-related

Q39. The self-advocacy dilemma means...

- A. Not advocating hurts you; advocating may look arrogant
- B. Let your boss decide
- C. Always speak up
- D. Always stay silent

Q40. An energizer...

- A. Tires others
- B. Reports to the CEO
- C. Controls budgets
- D. Leaves others feeling more driven

Q41. Drainers in an energy network have...

- A. Only mutual arrows
- B. Many incoming arrows
- C. No arrows
- D. Many outgoing, few incoming arrows

Q42. Discretionary effort is...

- A. Paid bonus work
- B. Voluntary extra effort
- C. Formal duties
- D. Mandatory overtime

Q43. The three protection strategies include...

- A. Raise your rank
- B. Increase coercion
- C. Minimise biases
- D. Ignore the tactic

Q44. Defence against liking tactics:

- A. Vote publicly
- B. Minimise dialogue before deciding
- C. Add more allies
- D. Chat more

Q45. Defence against availability: ask...

- A. Fewer questions
- B. Emotional ones
- C. Only vivid examples
- D. Counterfactual questions

Q46. When reframing, you should NOT...

- A. Undermine your manager's legitimate power
- B. Use your expertise
- C. Use your information
- D. Shift your power base

Q47. Manipulation is...

- A. Always honest
- B. Self-serving, unfair influence
- C. Always coercive
- D. Group-serving

Q48. The Stanford Prison Experiment was led by...

- A. Zimbardo
- B. Emerson
- C. Milgram
- D. Asch

Q49. Which is TRUE about Milgram vs Asch?

- A. Both = reciprocity
- B. Both = abuse of power
- C. Milgram = conformity; Asch = obedience
- D. Milgram = obedience; Asch = conformity

Mock Drill — Answer Key

1. D	11. C	21. B	31. A	41. D
2. C	12. B	22. C	32. B	42. B
3. C	13. B	23. A	33. D	43. C
4. A	14. D	24. C	34. A	44. B
5. A	15. B	25. A	35. A	45. D
6. A	16. B	26. D	36. A	46. A
7. D	17. C	27. C	37. B	47. B
8. D	18. B	28. A	38. B	48. A
9. C	19. B	29. B	39. A	49. D
10. C	20. B	30. C	40. D	

Score yourself

Score	Meaning
40-50	Exam-ready
30-39	Good — revise red boxes and missed items
25-29	Borderline pass — redo Module quizzes
Below 25	Re-read modules and Confusion Busters, retry

Full answers with the correct option

Q	Answer
1	D. Potential to influence
2	C. Referent (charisma)
3	C. Priming
4	A. Despite resistance
5	A. Creativity ↑
6	A. Overconfidence
7	D. Holding valued or rare information
8	D. Position
9	C. Values
10	C. Asymmetrical control over outcomes
11	C. Open communication and team performance
12	B. Legitimate
13	B. Risk-seeking
14	D. Copy similar others
15	B. Authority
16	B. Social proof
17	C. Scarcity
18	B. Reciprocity
19	B. Anchoring
20	B. Liking / attractiveness
21	B. Likeable and persuasive
22	C. Cortisol

Q	Answer
23	A. Early morning or after food
24	C. Products AND customers/geographies
25	A. Customers, suppliers, partners
26	D. Areas between verticals with limited authority
27	C. Conformity
28	A. White lab coat
29	B. 16%
30	C. 50% of organisational life
31	A. Advice/information ties
32	B. A person
33	D. More informal power
34	A. More power
35	A. The network collapses if one person is removed
36	A. 4
37	B. Position-related currencies
38	B. Relationship-related currencies
39	A. Not advocating hurts you; advocating may look arrogant
40	D. Leaves others feeling more driven
41	D. Many outgoing, few incoming arrows
42	B. Voluntary extra effort
43	C. Minimise biases
44	B. Minimise dialogue before deciding
45	D. Counterfactual questions
46	A. Undermine your manager's legitimate power
47	B. Self-serving, unfair influence
48	A. Zimbardo
49	D. Milgram = obedience; Asch = conformity

This guide was built from the transcripts of the Influencing People course videos, over 18,000 words of lecture content. The transcripts went through 4+ rounds of processing: extraction, merging, de-duplication and fact-checking. Every key term, number, named list and study is kept, with the high-chance MCQ points highlighted. The result is a short, exam-focused guide with practice questions and a full 50-question mock exam.

Prepared By @alliance.guide INSTAGRAM

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